

FUTURE READY AI

Curriculum Framework & Scope and Sequence

*K-12 AI literacy pathways for AI Discoverers, AI Explorers, and AI
Innovators*

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1. Curriculum Purpose

Future Ready AI provides a connected K-12 pathway that helps students understand artificial intelligence, use it responsibly, evaluate its outputs, create thoughtfully, and connect emerging technology to real-world learning and careers.

Design Commitment Human judgment, student creativity, responsible use, and age-

2. The Six Future Ready AI Curriculum Pillars

Pillar	Curriculum Emphasis
AI Foundations	Understanding what artificial intelligence is,
Creativity and Innovation	Using AI thoughtfully to support inquiry,
Responsible and Ethical AI	Examining privacy, bias, fairness,
Prompting and Communication	Learning how questions, instructions, context,
Critical Thinking and Media Literacy	Evaluating accuracy, recognizing
Digital Citizenship and Future Readiness	Building responsible technology habits while

3. Future Ready AI Learning Cycle

1. Launch

Introduce a question, scenario, challenge, or real-world problem.

2. Explore

Investigate examples, tools, ideas, evidence, and possible approaches.

3. Explain

Build understanding through discussion, modeling, and direct instruction.

4. Create

Apply learning through a product, solution, performance task, or prototype.

5. Reflect

Evaluate choices, outcomes, responsible use, and the role of human judgment.

6. Extend

Connect the learning to another subject, career, community, or emerging challenge.

4. Grade-Band Scope and Sequence

AI Discoverers — Elementary School

Unit	Title	Learning Focus
Unit 1	What Is Artificial Intelligence?	Recognize everyday
Unit 2	Humans, Machines, and	Explore sorting, classification,
Unit 3	Asking Good Questions	Practice clear questions and
Unit 4	Creativity With AI	Use age-appropriate tools to
Unit 5	AI Images and Media	Notice clues, ask who created
Unit 6	Safe and Responsible	Protect privacy, follow

AI Explorers — Middle School

Unit	Title	Learning Focus
Unit 1	How AI Systems Work	Examine data, patterns,
Unit 2	Prompting and	Write, test, compare, and
Unit 3	Media Literacy and	Evaluate claims, compare
Unit 4	Bias and Representation	Identify missing perspectives,
Unit 5	Privacy and Digital Footprints	Examine data collection,
Unit 6	Collaborative AI Projects	Apply AI literacy to a team

AI Innovators — High School

Unit	Title	Learning Focus
Unit 1	Applied AI Literacy	Analyze AI systems, intended
Unit 2	Prompt Engineering and	Design structured prompts,
Unit 3	Ethics and Governance	Evaluate accountability,
Unit 4	Bias, Data, and Decision-	Investigate how data and
Unit 5	Career and Entrepreneurship	Explore AI-enabled roles,
Unit 6	Capstone Innovation Project	Design and present a

5. Sample Lesson Portfolio

Elementary: Pattern Detectives: How Machines Notice Similarities

Students compare patterns and sorting rules to explore how machines classify information.

Middle School: Spotting the Difference: AI or Human-Made?

Students evaluate paired examples, identify clues, and explain how they verified their conclusions.

High School: Who Is Responsible When AI Makes a Decision?

Students analyze a decision-making scenario and evaluate fairness, accountability, transparency, and human oversight.

Career-Connected: Plan a Responsible Drone Mission

Students define a mission goal, review safety and privacy considerations, plan a flight path, and explain how data may support an industry need.

6. Project-Based Learning Examples

Elementary: AI creativity showcase, pattern investigation, or responsible-technology poster.

Middle School: Media-verification campaign, collaborative chatbot concept, or digital-citizenship challenge.

High School: Ethics investigation, career-connected challenge, responsible drone mission, or capstone innovation project.

7. Standards-Informed Design

Future Ready AI lessons are designed to support skills reflected in technology, computer science, digital citizenship, media literacy, communication, and career-readiness frameworks. A detailed standards crosswalk will be developed as curriculum units are finalized.

Frameworks informing development:

ISTE Student Standards

CSTA K-12 Computer Science Standards

AI4K12 Five Big Ideas

Digital citizenship and media-literacy competencies

Accuracy Note These frameworks inform curriculum development. The curriculum should not

8. Assessment Approach

Assessment is embedded throughout the learning process and emphasizes understanding, judgment, responsible use, communication, and application—not simply tool proficiency.

Formative checks

Student reflection prompts

Discussion and collaboration rubrics

Responsible-use checklists

Scenario-based assessments

Project and capstone rubrics